D.J. PARIS

"OPEN FLOOR PLAN" IS COSTING SELLERS MONEY.

Zillow's own research found the number, and the fix that sells for more.

D.J. Paris
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ONE LISTING PHRASE IS QUIETLY LOWERING THE SALE PRICE.

Zillow's research ties it to homes selling for less than expected, not more.

THE PHRASE SOUNDS LIKE A SELLING POINT. THE SALE PRICE SAYS OTHERWISE.

Zillow found homes described with "open floor plan" sold for 0.2 percent less than expected. Almost half the homeowners Zillow surveyed picked that exact phrase as the feature most likely to raise their price. It does the opposite. Homes that name real materials instead, like white oak flooring, walnut cabinets, and soapstone counters, sold for as much as 3.5 percent more.

THE SWAP, LISTING BY LISTING:

1 **Don't write "open floor plan."**
It reads as a selling point and Zillow's own data says it sells for less.

2 **Do walk the house and name what it's made of.**
White oak floors, walnut cabinets, soapstone counters, whatever is actually there.

3 **Don't name a material the house doesn't have.**
Only list what you can point to in the room. A wrong claim costs more than a vague one.

THE TAKEAWAY

WRITE DOWN WHAT THE HOUSE IS MADE OF, NOT WHAT THE LAYOUT LOOKS LIKE.

The description that names materials is the one that sells for more.

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